

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Dealing with identity theft.



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know someone who has experienced identity theft?
- What steps can you take to avoid having your personal information stolen?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about emotions, opinions, money and work.
- I can speculate about the past in a written way.
- I can write about hypothetical situations in the past.





Let's Explore!

Sally is speaking with the bank teller about protecting her accounts. She feels very **exposed***.

* Feeling "exposed" means to feel unprotected.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Hello, I would like to speak with someone about opening a new bank account. I have recently been a victim of identity theft. Thieves must have accessed my personal details somehow and affected my finances. Here is the police report that details the nightmare I am living through.
- Bank Teller:** Yes, Miss Davis. Our branch manager has spoken to us. If I had received such news, I would have been devastated. Were the police able to apprehend the offenders?
- Sally:** They are still on the case. If I had known that winning a large sum of money would cause so many headaches, I would have hidden my excitement.
- Bank Teller:** I see ... Did you keep the information to yourself?
- Sally:** No ... not really. I must have told too many people about my luck ... I feel so violated.
- Bank Teller:** That could have been the case. You currently hold two accounts with us, your credit card and a personal account.
- Sally:** I'd like to close the personal account and open another one with a different password. I'd like my monthly pay to be transferred to the new one.
- Bank Teller:** I think that's for the best. You will need to give your employer your new banking details.
- Sally:** I think I must have done that when I changed banks a couple years ago.
- Bank Teller:** While you are here you may want to change the password on your credit card and update your security questions. The suspects may have accessed that information as well.
- Sally:** If I had recognized that, I would have made my answers more complicated.
- Bank Teller:** A lot of people make that mistake. Repetitions or simple answers are not sufficient.

**Let's Practice!**

Sally and the bank teller discuss Sally's dilemma.

Instructions: Choose the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

Word Bank

had known / received / had recognized / would have hidden

1. If I _____ that winning a large sum of money would cause so many headaches, I _____ my excitement.
2. If I _____ that, I would have made my answers more complicated.
3. If I have _____ such news, I would have been devastated.

**Let's Practice!**

Sally thinks about her current situation.

Instructions: Select the incorrect word in the sentence. Read the corrected sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. That could have bin the case.
2. I think I must has done that when I changed banks a couple years ago.
3. I must have tell too many people about my luck.
4. Thieves missed have accessed my personal details somehow and affected my finances.
5. It might have change my entire life.





Extension Activity

Role play opening a bank account.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Read the dialogue between the teller and Sally.
- Talk to a partner about the information you need to open a bank account.
- Role play opening a bank account.
- Say what type of account you want.
- Use some of the vocabulary from the dialogue.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about money in a dialogue.

☐
☐

I role play opening a bank account with a partner.

☐
☐

I use vocabulary related to money and banking.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **thief** (noun): someone who steals things from another person or place
e.g. Thieves must have accessed my personal details.
- **branch manager** (noun): someone who manages a bank branch
e.g. Miss Davis, our branch manager has spoken to us.
- **to apprehend** (verb): to capture a law offender
e.g. Were the police able to apprehend the offenders?
- **to violate** (verb): to disobey or do something against an official agreement or law
e.g. I must have told too many people about my luck ... I feel so violated.
- **sufficient** (adjective): as much as is needed for a particular purpose
e.g. Repetitions or simple answers are not sufficient.
- **case** (noun): an example of a particular situation
e.g. That could have been the case.





Learning Points

Speculating About The Past

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty and speculate about things in the past.

You use modals to explain what is definitely true, probably true, possibly true, or impossible from the speaker's viewpoint.

When you are almost 100 percent positive that something is true, you use *must have* or *had to have*.

***must have* + past participle**

This structure is called the *perfect infinitive*.

We use ***must* + past participle** when we feel sure about something in the past.

When you are less certain if something is true, you use *may have*, *might have*, or *could have*.

***might/may/could* + past participle**

We use ***might*, *may* or *could*** with the **past participle** to say that we think something was possible but we aren't sure.

Modal Phrase	Meaning
<i>must have</i>	It is very likely
<i>may have</i> <i>might have</i> <i>could have</i>	It is possible

Examples:

- That ***could have*** been the case.
- I think I ***must have*** done that when I changed banks a couple years ago.
- I ***must have*** told too many people about my luck.
- Thieves ***must have*** accessed my personal details somehow and affected my finances.
- It ***might have*** changed my entire life.





Learning Points

If Clauses With The Past Perfect tense

You use *if* clauses with the Past Perfect form to indicate time that is in the past. The situation is not real, it did not happen. The facts are opposite.

This type of conditional is used to indicate an unreal past condition. The *if* clause uses the Past Perfect tense and the main clause uses the Perfect Conditional.

Only the word "if" is used with the Past Unreal Conditional because you are discussing imaginary situations. "When" cannot be used.

Here are two structures:

[If ... Past Perfect ..., ... would have + past participle ...]

and

[... would have + past participle ... if ... Past Perfect ...]

Examples:

- *If I had known that winning a large sum of money would cause so many headaches, I would have hidden my excitement.*
- *If I had recognized that, I would have made my answers more complicated.*
- *If I had received such news, I would have been devastated.*

